



A WORDS HAVE WEATHER STORY EBOOK

Zahra and the Group Chat Storm

A full stop has no face



THE HOOK

One full stop

One full stop turned a joke into a storm.
On Zahra's screen, Leo had written
only: "Fine."



THE FAST STORY

Zahra adds a face

Zahra heard an eye-roll. She pictured a smirk. Her fingers answered the face she had imagined, not the three letters Leo had sent.



POSSIBLE WORD-WEATHER

Two rooms, one storm

Across town, Leo stared at Zahra's reply. Willo watched the storm stretch between two quiet rooms. Neither screen showed the voice behind the words.



THE PAUSE

No faces in a message

The next day Arthur found them at opposite ends of a library table. "A message has no face," he said. "Ask before you lend it one."



TRY THE NEXT SENTENCE

Check meaning

Zahra put her tablet face-down. "When I read 'fine', I thought you were angry. Was that what you meant?"



AN ANSWER

The missing voice

Leo shook his head. He had been hurrying to dinner. "I meant the poster plan was fine. I didn't know it sounded sharp."



REPAIR

Slow enough to hear

They agreed: if a message felt hot, they would pause. No screenshots. No forwarding. First, one question in private.



READ IT AGAIN

Fact, guess or question?

Fact: Leo wrote a short reply. Guess: Leo was angry. Question: "Was that what you meant?" A question makes room for information the screen cannot carry.



TRY IT TOGETHER

Give the message three voices

Read the same short sentence as rushed, cheerful and annoyed. Which parts are visible in text? Create a family or class rule for hot messages: pause, keep it private, check.



WILLO WONDERS

What stayed private?

Zahra asked Leo directly. She did not recruit an audience, post a screenshot or demand an immediate answer. Repair had a smaller, safer room.

Adult notes

Key message: text removes tone, so check meaning before acting on an interpretation. Try: (1) label examples fact, guess or question; (2) write a three-step hot-message plan; (3) compare a message with an in-person version. Keep examples fictional, never project a child's real chat to a group, and follow school or family online-safety procedures where harm is possible.

